

Scaffolding & Extension Prompt Templates

Scaffold down or up using whichever prompt matches the student at hand.

Part 1: Scaffolding Down

For when a text is too advanced for where a student's at right now.

The Prompt

Act as a [subject area] specialist. Below is a grade-level text or material about [topic]. Generate an alternate version for a student reading at a [target grade/Lexile level] instructional tier, below the original level. Do not change the core facts, concepts, or required academic benchmarks. Keep the technical terms, but provide a bracketed definition or margin-based vocabulary callout box immediately following each term. Format the output with clear headers and bullet points to reduce cognitive load.
[Paste the text or material below this line]

What Goes in the Brackets

- [subject area] — the field, not the exact unit. “Life science,” not “photosynthesis unit 3”
- [topic] — just say what it’s about
- [target grade/Lexile level] — where this kid is actually reading, not where the class sits on average

Quick Check Before You Run It

- ☐ Named an actual reading level, not just “easier”
 - ☐ Said what has to stay — facts, vocabulary, standards
 - ☐ Filled in the subject area, didn’t leave it generic
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Part 2: Extension Up

For when a kid's already through the text and needs more than it's asking of them.

The Prompt

Act as a [subject area] specialist. Below is a grade-level text or material about [topic]. Generate an alternate version for a student ready for a [target grade/Lexile level] instructional tier, above the original level. Increase text complexity, sentence structure, and vocabulary demand while keeping the core facts and concepts accurate. Do not add vocabulary definitions or simplification supports — this version should challenge, not assist. Format the output with clear headers and bullet points.
[Paste the text or material below this line]

What Goes in the Brackets

- [subject area] — the field, not the exact unit. “Life science,” not “photosynthesis unit 3”
- [topic] — just say what it’s about
- [target grade/Lexile level] — where this kid’s actually ready to go, not where the class sits on average

Quick Check Before You Run It

- ☐ Named an actual target level, not just “harder”
- ☐ Said what has to stay accurate — facts and concepts
- ☐ Filled in the subject area, didn't leave it generic